

DIRECTIONS



COMPASSION-A-THON 3.0

From Idea to MVP — And Beyond, Into Incubation



IMPORTANT LINKS

**DETAILED TIMELINE &
MILESTONES**

[CLICK HERE TO VIEW](#)

**GUIDELINE DOCUMENT &
SUBMISSION FORMS**

[CLICK HERE TO VIEW](#)



CONTACT US :

Email	business.io@study.iitm.ac.in
Website	https://compassionathon.framer.website/



TIMELINE & MILESTONES



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OVERVIEW

Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 is a pre-pre-incubation innovation challenge; a competition designed to nurture socially impactful, technically sound, and compassion-driven entrepreneurial ideas into incubation-ready ventures and real businesses.

As official **KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS** of **COMPASSION-A-THON 3.0**, [SPIRELIA](#) plays a pivotal role in shaping the entrepreneurial journeys of budding innovators by bridging the gap between raw ideas and viable minimum viable products (MVPs). The initiative aims to bring together students from diverse domains to identify real-world problems, iterate meaningful solutions, and pitch prototypes in a high-impact, collaborative environment.

This edition additionally focuses on strengthening inclusivity and encouraging greater participation from women entrepreneurs while enabling shortlisted ventures to gain visibility among industry mentors, startup founders, and incubation ecosystems for potential mentorship and incubation support.

THIS YEAR'S EDITION EMPHASIZES

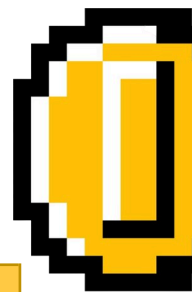
- ⚡ Early-stage entrepreneurial exploration through structured startup templates
- ⚡ Real-world validation through customer interviews and feedback cycles
- ⚡ Hands-on prototyping and MVP building
- ⚡ Encouraging inclusivity and participation from women entrepreneurs
- ⚡ Startup-oriented thinking and market validation
- ⚡ Guidance from mentors, founders, faculty, and innovation experts
- ⚡ A final on-campus presentation round with jury interaction
- ⚡ Visibility opportunities among incubation and startup ecosystems
- ⚡ Incentives and recognition for innovation, execution, and customer validation



DETAILED TIMELINE & MILESTONES

MILESTONE	TIMELINE (Tentative)	DESCRIPTION	Status
MILESTONE 1			
Competition Begins : Pre-Pre-Incubator Template Reveal (Online)	18th May 2026	Helps anchor ideation  Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 Pre-Pre-Incubation ...	In Progress ▾
Idea Submission Window Opens (Online)	25th May, 2025 <i>tentatively</i>	Teams submit detailed ideas based upon the template designed for pre-incubation readiness. https://forms.gle/Ushx6URqpYrCFLkU9	Yet To Start ▾
Empathize, Prototyping & Customer Testing: Final Submission (Online)	<i>Deadline</i> 31st May 2025	Teams start working on building their prototypes, taking customer interviews of idea prototypes or the solution(s) and submit their final presentations [Slide numbers 1 to 7]	Yet To Start ▾
MILESTONE 2			
On-Campus Workshop (Offline)	June 11th, 2025 10:00 AM onwards	Grand Finale POD Workshop on transforming ideas into scalable, incubation-ready MVPs through venture thinking, validation, and execution by Prof. Bala Ramadurai	Yet To Start ▾
On-Campus Customer Testimonials (Offline)	June 11th, 2025 13:00 to 18:00 Office Hours	Teams to refine their solutions, build prototypes, and prepare for live pitches, and approach customers on campus. [Slide number 8]	Yet To Start ▾
Pitch Finale (Offline)	June 12th, 2025 10:00 AM onwards	Final presentations from shortlisted teams, jury evaluations, and result declaration.	Yet To Start ▾





EVALUATION RUBRIC

EVALUATION HEADING	CRITERIA	POINTS
Ideation	Clear problem-solution fit; aligns with Compassion-A-thon (nearness to pre-incubation)	20
Branding & Prototyping	Prototype readiness, design principles & interviews	20
Testing	Based on the testing phase : No. of prototype iterations, feedback cycles	20
Documentation	Clear submission(s), visual aids, on-campus presence	20
ELIGIBILITY		
EVALUATION HEADING	DESCRIPTION	
Online Customer Interviews	Mandatory for qualifying into the final round.	
On-Campus Interviews	Mandatory for qualifying into the final round.	
BONUS POINTS - TBD		

Contact Us :

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All the best to every participant—may the best innovator win!



GUIDELINES



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Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 | Paradox 2026 Guideline Document

Welcome to Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 !

Welcome to Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 ! Congratulations on stepping into one of the flagship pre-pre-incubation innovation challenges of the IIT Madras BS Degree community. This document is your one-stop reference guide for every step, milestone, workshop, submission process, and resource you'll need throughout this entrepreneurial journey.

Whether you're an aspiring entrepreneur, a problem-solver, a builder, or a curious innovator looking to create meaningful impact, this is your opportunity to transform ideas into validated MVPs with support from faculty, incubated startups, industry mentors, innovation coaches, and startup founders.

Compassion-A-Thon 3.0 aims to bridge the gap between raw ideas and incubation-ready ventures through customer validation, mentorship, prototype building, and entrepreneurial learning.

Eligibility :

You are eligible for this competition if you meet the following conditions :

- You are a BS degree student at IIT Madras (DS or ES or MG or AS), at any level.
- You are registered for Paradox 2026 and will be able to attend the Finale at IIT Madras.

2. Hackathon Rules

1. Teams must consist of 2-5 students currently enrolled in BS programs. (Individual participation is not allowed).
2. A member must be part of only one team.
3. All team members participating in this event must register with Paradox'26 and comply with any program-level guidelines, official rules, code of conduct, and non-disclosure agreements.
4. All submissions and presentations or videos must be delivered in English with exceptions on request.
5. You may not make direct contact with judges and speakers of the event related to the competition.
6. Teams are welcome to bring their own or affiliated existing startup concepts but are expected to actively undertake all hackathon activities - customer interviews, root cause analysis, prototype creation, business plan formulation, and presentation to judges for evaluation.
7. Teams may seek a mentor (this includes professors in the field of design thinking, innovation, marketing and entrepreneurship or even working professionals, and startup

- enthusiasts).
8. You may consult published works in the field of innovation or technology and solicit help from your mentor.
 9. **Top 25 Shortlisted Teams Work on Slide 8 as soon we release Milestone 02 results.**

Milestone 01 :

Competition Begins - Pre-Pre-Incubation Template Reveal (Online)

Submission Form Link : [Submit Here](#)

Slides 1–3 Startup Information

You will receive access to a Google Form and a working template, which once filled, will act as your stepping stone in this journey :

- ♦ You must make a copy of the original Google Slides template
- ♦ Fill in the required fields ONLY (do not modify structure)
- ♦ Submit the “Anyone with link can view” shareable link in the provided form
- ♦ This is your working deck for the judging team

Slides 4–6 Empathize & Prototype Building (Online)

- ♦ Prototyping (Low-fidelity or wireframes encouraged)
- ♦ Customer Interview Planning
- ♦ Building a minimal prototype (with prototyping tools or fully coded if feasible)

Slides 7 Customer Testing Phase (Online)

- ♦ Conduct customer interviews
- ♦ Refine prototypes and presentation based on feedback
- ♦ Complete Slide 7 for user response & validation

Milestone 02 :

A. On-Campus POD Workshop (Offline)

Date: June 11th, 2026 | Time: 11:00 AM onwards

- ♦ Sessions with mentors, experts, and prior startup founders
- ♦ Guided refinement of ideas
- ♦ Help finalize prototype & customer pitch decks

B. Customer Testing Continued + Office Hours (Offline)

Date: June 11th, 2025 | Time: 1:00 PM onwards

- ♦ Use this time to test refined solutions with real users or customers
 - ♦ Expert help desks will be live
 - ♦ Complete Slide 8 for On Campus Customer Interviews
-



Pitch Finale

Live Presentations of Top 10 Shortlisted Teams (Offline)

Date: June 12th, 2026 | Time: 10:00 AM onwards

- ♦ Use this time to test refined solutions with real users or customers
 - ♦ Final Presentation in front of Jury Panel
 - ♦ Top Teams selected for incubation interest/mentorship + spotlight features
-

Template Submission Process

A Google Form will be shared to complete the preliminary template submission process:

- Access the main template link.
 - Make a copy of the slide deck to your Google Drive.
 - Fill in the required slides as per the milestone.
 - Set link access to "Anyone with the link can view".
 - Paste your slide link in the submission form.
 - Once submitted, your deck will be monitored live by mentors and judges for feedback, evaluation, and tracking.
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Key Notes to Remember

- Use only your official IITM BS Degree Google account for access
 - Submit before the mentioned deadline per milestone
 - Make sure slide permissions are correct, judges will not request access at any point
 - Keep updating the same slide link for every milestone
 - Reach out if you face technical access or submission issues
-



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Let's make this competition an unforgettable journey of learning, innovation, and impact.

This is not about numbers, it's about ideas that solve, and we're bringing in big names to help your idea take flight.

All the best, and let the venture building begin!

Best Wishes,

Team Compassion-A-Thon 3.0

Declaration

All regulations, including policies, codes of conduct, and honor codes established by IIT Madras, particularly those pertaining to the IIT Madras BS Degree programs - Student Affairs, Paradox and Academic/Non-Academic Rules, apply to this event. This competition is structured as a business innovation hackathon. We do not reserve any patent rights over idea submissions, nor do we mandate disclosure.



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